CHAPTER FIVE:
FORGED IN IRON

In a film as effects-driven as Iron Man 2, planning is essential. And storyboards are a key to that planning. By mapping scenes out, shot-by-shot, it becomes possible to coordinate the live footage with all the additional layers of post-production.

Co-Producer and Visual Effects Supervisor Victoria Alonso elaborates that the 'practical effects' is everything that you get to do in camera. So anytime you need to do anything you can actually capture on set, on location, live—those are all special effects. 'Visual effects' is augmentation of the practical effect, or is everything that you have to do digitally later.

"So, for example, if we were to have an explosion, Dan Sudick and his team will have the big explosion live. We will, in turn, comp in the entire Stark Expo. We will fly in Iron Man, we will fly in War Machine, and we'll make sure that the entire shot is composited, as if we did it all in that one take."

Storyboarding scenes in an action movie like Iron Man also creates a special kind of moviemaking magic, when new opportunities are discovered, and new roads opened. On the following pages, two important sequences from Iron Man 2 are presented in their storyboard form.

